

1 / 5 | Ages 7-8 | 15 minutes

Pack for the pretend trip

What we are practising

Prioritize needs within a simple limit.

What you need

Paper / Pencil

Name the items aloud rather than drawing cards.

Before you begin

Imagine a two-hour shaded park visit with an adult and space for four item types.

This is pretend planning; an adult decides actual travel supplies and any individual health needs.

Try it together

1. List six possible items, such as water, hat, snack, notebook, toy and spare shirt.
2. Choose four and explain the reason for each.
3. Change the scenario to an indoor visit and reconsider the choices.
4. Agree which choices depend on weather or personal needs.

Talk, draw or show your idea

Which item serves an essential need, and which is an optional extra?

Space to explore

2 / 5 | Ages 7-8 | 15 minutes

A fair turn-taking plan

What we are practising

State a preference, listen and agree on a practical turn rule.

What you need

One shared drawing sheet / Two pencils

Use imaginary turns on a pretend swing.

Before you begin

Choose a shared drawing goal, such as a garden.

Keep it voluntary and stop if the game becomes upsetting; adults handle real disputes that need help.

Try it together

1. Each person says one thing they want to add.
2. Agree on turns, such as one feature per turn.
3. Take four turns each and notice whether the rule works.
4. If someone needs more help or time, agree on an adjustment together.

Talk, draw or show your idea

Is a fair agreement always exactly the same for everyone?

Space to explore

3 / 5 | Ages 7-8 | 15 minutes

Morning routine puzzle

What we are practising

Plan a sequence that satisfies more than one condition.

What you need

Paper / Pencil

Draw the five actions rather than writing them.

Before you begin

Use these actions: get dressed, eat breakfast, brush teeth, pack bag, leave.

These are fictional puzzle rules; follow your family's actual care routine.

Try it together

1. Write each action on a separate large paper card or in a list.
2. Apply the rules: breakfast before brushing teeth; packing before leaving; leaving last.
3. Choose one order that follows all rules.
4. Find a different valid order and explain what moved.

Talk, draw or show your idea

Which parts are fixed by the rules, and which are flexible?

Space to explore

4 / 5 | Ages 7-8 | 15 minutes

Ask a useful question

What we are practising

Notice ambiguity and ask a specific clarification question.

What you need

Paper / Pencil

Use spoken role-play only.

Before you begin

An adult prepares vague fictional requests such as put the book over there.

Use harmless pretend requests; children can decline requests that feel unsafe or uncomfortable.

Try it together

1. Listen to one vague request without acting on it.
2. Name the missing detail, such as which book or which place.
3. Ask a precise question, then repeat the clarified instruction.
4. Swap roles using another harmless request.

Talk, draw or show your idea

Which question would help more: what? or which shelf?

Space to explore

5 / 5 | Ages 7-8 | 20 minutes

Make a shared-space checklist

What we are practising

Break a practical job into observable, manageable steps.

What you need

Paper / Pencils / A small drawing area

Use an imaginary desk drawn on paper.

Before you begin

Choose a small safe area and agree what ready to use means.

Adults handle cleaning chemicals, sharp items and heavy objects; this task uses only safe art materials.

Try it together

1. List three visible actions, such as cap pens, stack paper and return pencils.
2. Put the actions in a useful order and add checkboxes.
3. Test the checklist together after a short drawing session.
4. Change any instruction that was unclear or too large.

Talk, draw or show your idea

How will someone know each step is finished?

Space to explore

For the grown-up

Use these prompts when useful. Open-ended activities can have many good answers. Let your child explain their thinking.

1. Pack for the pretend trip

A little hint

Think about thirst, weather and the planned activity before entertainment.

Answer / what to notice

Several lists can work; water is a strong priority for the park, and choices should have reasons suited to the scenario.

A useful packing list responds to the situation rather than including everything available.

Make it easier

Choose two items from four picture options.

Take it further

Assign each item a size of 1 or 2 and fit a total capacity of 6.

Another day, away from the screen

Help an adult check a real outing list without sharing it online.

For the grown-up

Use these prompts when useful. Open-ended activities can have many good answers. Let your child explain their thinking.

2. A fair turn-taking plan

A little hint

A useful rule is clear and can adapt to a person's needs.

Answer / what to notice

Any agreed rule can work if both can participate and ask for changes respectfully.

Fairness includes being heard and having a workable chance to take part.

Make it easier

An adult models one request and one response.

Take it further

Include a third person and agree how to handle an unfinished turn.

Another day, away from the screen

Use the agreed phrases in another low-stakes shared game.

For the grown-up

Use these prompts when useful. Open-ended activities can have many good answers. Let your child explain their thinking.

3. Morning routine puzzle

A little hint

Nothing in these puzzle rules says when getting dressed must happen.

Answer / what to notice

One answer is dressed, breakfast, teeth, bag, leave. Another is breakfast, dressed, bag, teeth, leave.

The rules limit the order but do not determine a single solution.

Make it easier

Use just breakfast, teeth and leave.

Take it further

Add estimated durations and calculate a departure time.

Another day, away from the screen

Make a flexible checklist for a familiar non-urgent routine.

For the grown-up

Use these prompts when useful. Open-ended activities can have many good answers. Let your child explain their thinking.

4. Ask a useful question

A little hint

Ask about one missing detail at a time.

Answer / what to notice

For put the book over there, useful questions include which book? and where exactly should it go?

Specific questions reduce uncertainty and let both people check the same meaning.

Make it easier

Choose a question from two adult-provided options.

Take it further

Clarify a task with two separate missing details.

Another day, away from the screen

Notice one everyday instruction that could be made clearer.

For the grown-up

Use these prompts when useful. Open-ended activities can have many good answers. Let your child explain their thinking.

5. Make a shared-space checklist

A little hint

Replace tidy up with a specific action such as put all pencils in the box.

Answer / what to notice

A useful checklist has clear actions and a visible finish; different spaces need different lists.

Small specific steps make a shared task easier to understand and check.

Make it easier

Use two picture steps with adult help.

Take it further

Ask another person to follow the list without extra explanation and revise it.

Another day, away from the screen

Create a second checklist for putting away a board game.